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**NITI Aayog
transformed
policymaking
from a top-
down exercise
to a dynamic
process of co-
creation with
states, private
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civil society**

INDIA'S KNOWLEDGE ECONOMY

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▶ **IN A COUNTRY AS** vast and varied as India, the true measure of progress lies not merely in GDP figures or infrastructure milestones but in how well it nurtures its people. Human capital—our education, skills, health, and productivity—is not just an economic asset but a moral imperative. Over the last ten years, a quiet, yet formidable, revolution has taken shape under the stewardship of India's premier policy think tank, NITI Aayog, reshaping how the country invests in its most valuable resource: its citizens.

In a nation where over 65% of the population is below the age of 35, the demographic dividend presents a once-in-a-generation opportunity. But the sheer scale of this population brings enormous responsibility. The challenge lies in converting youthful energy into a force for economic growth and national development. This is where the NITI Aayog has emerged as a visionary catalyst—charting a road map not just for today's progress but also for tomorrow's prosperity.

Over the last decade, it has evolved from a think tank into

a reformist engine and an execution partner, known for bold ideas backed by data, collaboration, and human-centred design. It has transformed policymaking to a dynamic process of co-creation with states, private players, global institutions, and civil society. Its strength lies not just in planning, but in listening—and turning those insights into action.

Education has been completely reimaged under its guidance. Recognising that access alone isn't enough, the NITI Aayog pushed for quality and equity. The National Education Policy 2020, where it played a pivotal role, ushered in a new era—shifting from rote learning to critical thinking, flexibility, and vocational integration. It emphasised early childhood education, mother-tongue instruction, and seamless transitions between disciplines. Through initiatives like the Atal Innovation Mission, it ensured both accountability and imagination, embedding innovation in over 10,000 Atal Tinkering Labs.

Skilling India's youth for the 21st century has been another cornerstone. From backing the Skill India Mission to ensuring that vocational